[Prevention] Act) court came down to seven in the Supreme Court but the fate of the key conspirators such as Santhan, Murugan, Nalini and gang remained unaltered. The Jain Inquiry Commission, headed by Justice Milap Chand Jain, set up to look into the ‘larger conspiracy’ behind the assassination, was flooded with allegations against the P.V. Narasimha Rao government, slowing down the pace of inquiry and ignoring, hiding and suppressing vital evidence that could have led the investigators to the doorstep of some influential people in Delhi. But what nobody could throw light on was Rao’s motive.[1]

One of the finest officers in the SIT, Amit Verma was later inducted into the commission to assist Justice Jain. Incidentally, Verma had huge differences of opinion with his chief, D.R. Kaarthikeyan, over the possibility of a ‘foreign hand’ in the assassination. The commission was looking into one Amos Radia and Giorce Betchar as agents operating for the Israelis in India.

And in the days that followed, startling depositions and intelligence intercepts made before the commission indicated that Subramanian Swamy may have had prior knowledge of a threat to Rajiv and had communicated the same to the former Prime Minister’s party, but no one, whether in his party or the government, had reacted in a timely manner. In fact, Swamy had had an argument with the then Research and Analysis Wing (R&AW) chief in a Cabinet committee meeting that was held within hours of the killing. Justice Jain devoted separate chapters to three key Indian players who were suspected, one way or the other, to have had prior knowledge of the assassination. The evidence looked more circumstantial, though, but a political will to examine them further was shamelessly ignored by New Delhi.

In my journalism career spanning over ten years, there was no place better than *India Today* for investigating the Rajiv Gandhi assassination case. It was my greatest experience, the most rewarding and, yes, the most controversial. While *India Today* backed me to the hilt, there was no dearth of opposition. After the breaking story of how the conspiracy was hatched, a celebrated journalist from a southern daily accused me of yellow